Chapter Ten

Death of an Army

On the Korean peninsula between
1146 and 1197,
the king scorns the army,
the army overthrows the king,
and both army and king submit to
private power

ON THE PENINSULA east of China and west of Japan, a single king ruled over a single people. For over two centuries, Goryeo had been united under the same dynasty. Its people spoke the same language, worshipped in the same Buddhist temples, followed the same laws.*